

CONDITIONAL FORMATTING

→ used to automatically format cells based on conditions

Ex:- highlight high salaries
highlight low sales
find duplicates
show trends

Highlight Cells Rules

→ used to highlight cells matching a condition

Ex:- Greater than
Salary > 100000

Options: Greater than, less than, equal to, Text Contains

Top/Bottom Rules

→ used to identify highest & lowest values

Ex:- Top 10 items
Bottom 10 items
Above average
Below average

Data Bars

→ creates bars inside cells

Ex:-

10
20
30

→ Quick Comparison without creating a chart

Color Scales

→ creates a heat map

Ex:- low value → Red
Medium → Yellow
high value → Green

Useful for: Salary analysis
KPI dashboards
Performance reports

why color scale doesn't look right for total row?

Suppose: Salary

50k

60k

70k

180k (Total)

→ The total is much larger, so these all look green. & all other cells look similar

Solution: apply formatting only to data rows

Multiple Rows problem

Suppose: Salary

Profit

Revenue

→ each row needs separate color scales

option 1: apply formatting row by row

option 2: use format painter

Cell Styles

→ Prebuilt formatting styles used for quick formatting

Ex: Title, Heading 1, Heading 2, Good, Bad, Neutral

Clear formats

→ Removes formatting only

Removes:

- Colors

- Fonts

- Borders

- Conditional formatting

Keeps: data & formulas

Manage Rules

Path: Conditional formatting → Manage Rules.

Used to:

- View all rules

- Edit Rules

- Delete Rules

- Change priority

- Change ranges

Ex: Rule 1 : Salary > 100k → Green

Rule 2 : Salary > 150k → Blue.

→ manage rules lets you decide: which rule applies first

New Rule

→ lets you create custom formatting rules

Formula-based Rule

Ex: highlight salaries above average

formula : $=B2 > \text{AVERAGE}(\$B\$2 : \$B\$100)$

format : Green fill

→ all above average values become green.

why absolute reference?

Ex: $=\$B\$2 > \$C\2

→ Excel checks every row using that fixed reference

relative references

Ex: $=B2 > C2$

Excel automatically changes : $B3 > C3$
 $B4 > C4$

→ most conditional formatting formulas actually use relative references.

Note :- when creating formula

- lock reference range

- keep current row relative

Ex: $=B2 > \text{AVERAGE}(\$B\$2 : \$B\$100)$

Useful Custom Rules:

→ highlight entire row

Ex: highlight Data Scientists

formula : $=\$A2 = \text{"Data Scientist"}$

Applied range : A2 : H100

→ Entire row gets highlighted.